Zooming

Abi Harrison-Nye

What is it for?

Some people need to make the text and images on a website bigger to see them clearly. Pages must support this. When a user zooms in, the content should automatically rearrange itself to fit the screen. This is often called 'reflow'. A good page will reflow so that users never have to scroll from side to side to read a single sentence. This is very important for creating a positive experience for people with low vision.

All modern browsers support zooming. It's up to developers and designers to build layouts that still work when people zoom in.

How to support it

On a computer: hold Ctrl (or Cmd on a Mac) and press +. Check at 200%, then zoom to 400%. Can you read everything without scrolling left and right?

On a mobile: put two fingers on your screen, close to each other, and spread them apart.

NOTE: The 'pinch-to-zoom' feature must never be blocked. Disabling zoom creates a major barrier for accessibility.

Useful Links

Adrian Roselli - Don't Disable Zoom
CSS-Tricks - Accessible Font Sizing, Explained
WebAIM - Responsive Design and Reflow